ARI EPA Leverage Snapshot — 2025 REG

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About This Report

- **What it does:** Identifies the game situations where ARI underperformed league average the most, ranked by total EPA gap (per-play gap × play volume). Larger gaps = higher-leverage improvement areas.
- **How to read it:** Each section shows the gap, a general positional archetype that typically addresses it, and relevant free agents at that position.
- **Data source:** nflverse public play-by-play (2025 regular season). Free agent data from public contract databases.

Built as a portfolio project to demonstrate data pipeline and analytical thinking. Uses public data only — does not account for scheme, film, medical, or internal scouting context.

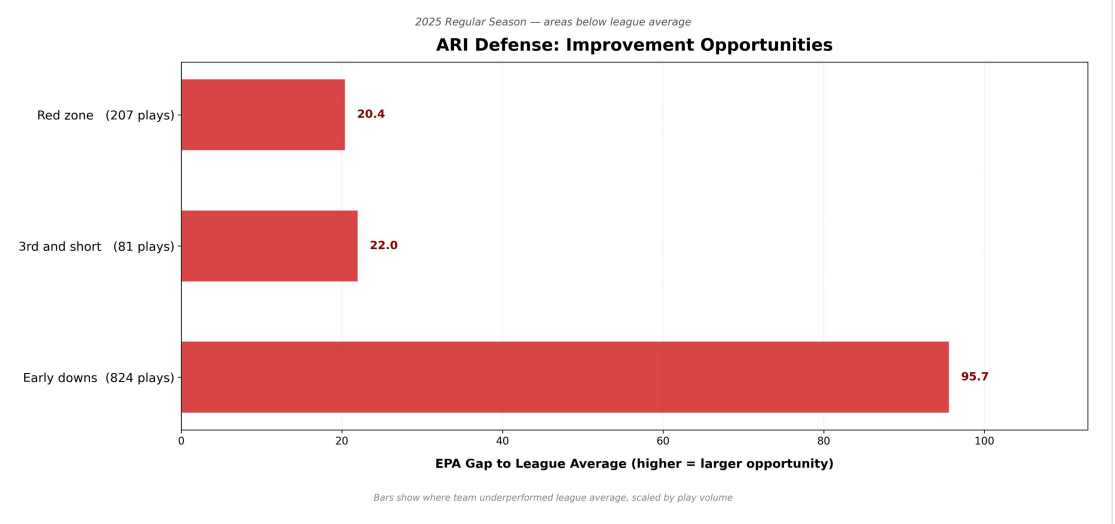
KEY FINDINGS

1. **Largest gap is on defense:** Early Downs (29th of 32) — 96 total EPA below league average.
2. **Top offensive gap:** 3rd & Long (≥7) (25th of 32) — 24 total EPA below league average.
3. **Explosive plays are a two-sided issue:** ARI creates them at 7.8% (league avg 9.6%) and allows them at 10.8%.

EXPLOSIVE PLAY RATES

OFF created	7.8% vs 9.6% LG
DEF allowed	10.8% vs 9.6% LG

Defense: Highest Leverage Gaps



DETAILED BREAKDOWN

bucket	plays	TEAM_EPA_per_play	LG_EPA_per_play	TEAM_success_rate	LG_success_rate	EPA_gap_to_LG	Rank
DEF: Early downs	824	0.132	0.016	0.490	0.440	95.658	29th/32
DEF: 3rd & short (<=4)	81	0.260	-0.012	0.667	0.562	22.042	30th/32
DEF: Red zone (<=20)	207	0.096	-0.003	0.444	0.423	20.447	24th/32

PRIORITY AREAS

Early Downs

(29th of 32) | 0.132 vs 0.016 LG EPA/play — 96 total EPA gap

Early-down defense is often driven by front-seven depth — the ability to win at the point of attack on 1st and 2nd down limits opponent drive length.

RELEVANT FREE AGENTS

Player	Pos / Age	Prev Team	Prior AAV
Devin Lloyd	LB | Age 27.2	JAX	$3.2M
Quay Walker	LB | Age 25.7	GB	$3.5M
Devin Bush	LB | Age 27.5	CLE	$3.2M

3rd & Short (≤4)

(30th of 32) | 0.260 vs -0.012 LG EPA/play — 22 total EPA gap

Short-yardage 3rd-down defense is often tied to pressure rate and the ability to disrupt timing routes at the line of scrimmage.

RELEVANT FREE AGENTS

Player	Pos / Age	Prev Team	Prior AAV
Alontae Taylor	CB | Age 27.1	NO	$1.8M
Roger McCreary	CB | Age 25.9	LAR	$2.3M
Jamel Dean	CB | Age 29.2	TB	$13.0M

Red Zone (≤20)

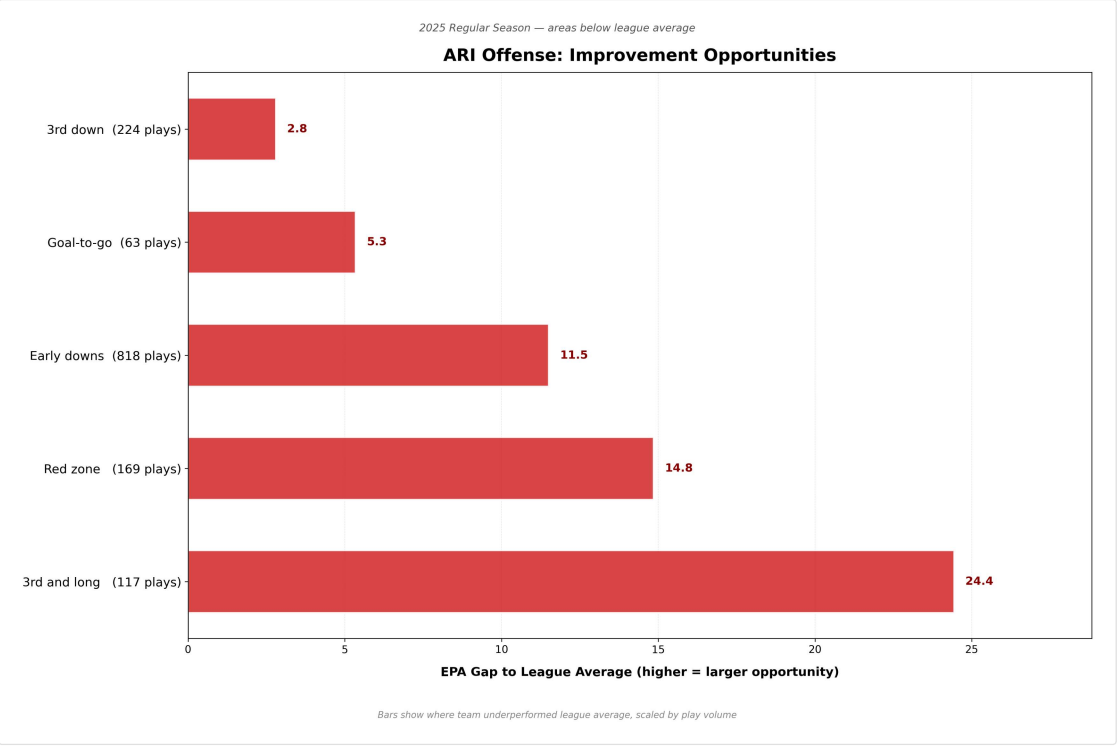
(24th of 32) | 0.096 vs -0.003 LG EPA/play — 20 total EPA gap

Red zone defense in condensed space typically correlates with interior run defense and press coverage ability.

RELEVANT FREE AGENTS

Player	Pos / Age	Prev Team	Prior AAV
Devin Lloyd	LB | Age 27.2	JAX	$3.2M
Alontae Taylor	CB | Age 27.1	NO	$1.8M
Greg Newsome	CB | Age 25.7	JAX	$3.2M

Offense: Highest Leverage Gaps



PRIORITY AREAS

3rd & Long (≥7)

(25th of 32) | -0.315 vs -0.106 LG EPA/play — 24 total EPA gap

3rd-and-long conversion rate is heavily influenced by QB accuracy on intermediate throws and receiver separation ability.

RELEVANT FREE AGENTS

Player	Pos / Age	Prev Team	Prior AAV
Keenan Allen	WR | Age 34	LAC	$3.0M
Christian Kirk	WR | Age 30	HOU	$18.0M
Wan'Dale Robinson	WR | Age 25	NYG	$2.0M

Red Zone (≤20)

(26th of 32) | -0.091 vs -0.003 LG EPA/play — 15 total EPA gap

Red zone offense in condensed space often benefits from contested-catch receivers and goal-line run-game quality.

RELEVANT FREE AGENTS

Player	Pos / Age	Prev Team	Prior AAV
Jauan Jennings	WR | Age 29	SF	$5.9M
Jahan Dotson	WR | Age 26	PHI	$3.8M
Adam Thielen	WR | Age 36	PIT	$5.0M

Early Downs

(22nd of 32) | 0.002 vs 0.016 LG EPA/play — 12 total EPA gap

Early-down offense sets up the rest of the drive — run-game efficiency and play-action success are common levers here.

RELEVANT FREE AGENTS

Player	Pos / Age	Prev Team	Prior AAV
Travis Etienne	RB | Age 27	JAX	$3.2M
Breece Hall	RB | Age 25	NYJ	$2.3M
Kenneth Walker III	RB | Age 26	SEA	$2.1M

DETAILED BREAKDOWN

bucket	plays	TEAM_EPA_per_play	LG_EPA_per_play	TEAM_success_rate	LG_success_rate	EPA_gap_to_LG	Rank
OFF: 3rd & long (>=7)	117	-0.315	-0.106	0.291	0.313	24.432	25th/32
OFF: Red zone (<=20)	169	-0.091	-0.003	0.385	0.423	14.845	26th/32
OFF: Early downs	818	0.002	0.016	0.427	0.440	11.500	22nd/32
OFF: Goal-to-go	63	-0.063	0.021	0.413	0.444	5.335	22nd/32
OFF: 3rd down	224	-0.065	-0.053	0.446	0.425	2.794	19th/32

EPA gap = difference between ARI and league-average efficiency, scaled by play volume. Rank among teams with ≥30 plays per bucket. Situational buckets overlap (e.g. red zone plays also appear in early-down totals) — gaps are not additive. Does not account for opponent quality, scheme, or injury context.